

Tremors: Perfection — Playtest Rules

**Co-op, solo-friendly.** Run Val → Earl → Rhonda → Burt. Complete the drawn Essentials, then **Evacuate from round 8+** (or still have them done when round 12 ends). Anyone Dragged or bled out from Critical = table loss. Prototype, not a published game. Pair with the printable map.

SETUP

12 rounds. Calamity on 4 / 7 / 9 / 11 / 12. Start with 3 **Rescue**, 2 **Medkits**. Draw 3 **Essential**, 2 **Optional**, 1 **Character** objective. Burt drafts 2 of 3 kit cards. Three Graboids start underground at Hunt 1 in different sectors. Starts: Val & Earl at Chang's, Rhonda at her camp, Burt at the compound.

TURN

Each character: **2 actions** (1 if Injured, Grabbed, or Pinned; 0 if Critical). Grabbed's action is Struggle. Pinned characters cannot move until helped up.

**Every action is at least 1 Noise** unless Rhonda took no Move this turn (Don't Move) or you spend a Quiet Move token (0 Noise).

| Action           | N               | Notes                                                                                          |
|------------------|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Move carefully   | +1              | 1 node. Ignores Shaken extra.                                                                  |
| Move             | +1              | Up to Movement. Shaken: +1.                                                                    |
| Run              | +2              | Farther, louder. Shaken: +1.                                                                   |
| Fast (Val)       | +2              | Move +1 space.                                                                                 |
| Quiet Move token | 0               | Spend a token.                                                                                 |
| Search           | +1              | d6 + Search + node S vs 9, then +1 per prior find here. Draw to shared supply.                 |
| Work objective   | max(1, printed) | Must be on its node. Tick 1 work.                                                              |
| Diversion        | +3              | Dump noise on an adjacent node.                                                                |
| Fight            | +3              | Same node, surfaced worm. d6 + Combat ≥ 8 = 1 wound. Heavy guns extra N. Miss: it attacks you. |
| Rescue           | +2              | Spend 1 Rescue token. Pull one node clear.                                                     |
| Struggle         | +1              | Grabbed only. Pull one node clear.                                                             |
| Use item / rig   | floor 1         | See items. Rigs spend two parts, one action.                                                   |
| Aid / unpin      | +1              | Share node. Aid spends a Medkit (Crit → Inj or Inj → Healthy).                                 |
| Stay quiet       | +1              | Dump leftover actions.                                                                         |
| Evacuate         | —               | Round 8+. All Essentials done. Nobody Grabbed or dead.                                         |

Signature Moments: once per game, listed on the character.

END OF ROUND

- Sum **Noise this round** → Graboid response. Surfaced worms chase the nearest character (1 step; Frenzy/Stampede: 2).
- If the round is 4, 7, 9, 11, or 12: draw a Calamity. Band by that same total: Quiet 0–8 / Disturbed 9–14 / Frenzy 15+.
- Critical timers tick (2 rounds → dead). Location noise **decays by 1**. Round noise resets. A surfaced Graboid that catches nobody for **2 rounds** submerges at Hunt 1.

NOISE & HUNT

Noise is **shared** and also sits on the node where it happened. After characters act:

| Round total          | Response                                             |
|----------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| 0–8 Quiet            | No extra move. Hunt still ticks.                     |
| 9–11 Movement        | Underground worms shift toward prey / loudest noise. |
| 12–14 Hunting        | Move, and +1 Hunt.                                   |
| 15–19 Feeding Frenzy | Activate twice (or extra Hunt).                      |
| 20+ Stampede         | A new Graboid enters; all hunt hard.                 |

Each Graboid phase, an **underground** worm in a sector gains Hunt from that sector's lingering noise: **+1** (0–4), **+2** (5–7), **+3** (8+), plus Aggression. **Hunt 2 = Surface** at the **loudest noise in that sector** (ties random). Tripwire Bait overrides the node and skips the ambush.

Kill a surfaced Graboid with **2 wounds** → immediately **+6 Noise**.

THE MODEL

Token = sector (underground). Model = node (surfaced). Sharing its node:

- Threatened** — first catch by *that* worm. Still mobile. Leave.
- Grabbed** — the same worm again. 1 action (Struggle). Rescue/Struggle pulls one node clear and breaks the grip.
- Dragged** — catch while Grabbed. Dead. Everyone loses.

If it attacks (you walk onto it, miss a Fight, or it bursts under you and buildings/towers don't save you), d6:

| d6  | Result                                                           |
|-----|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1–2 | Miss — Shaken.                                                   |
| 3   | Knockdown — Injured, Shaken.                                     |
| 4   | Pinned — Injured; cannot move until helped.                      |
| 5–6 | Grabbed (if already Threatened by it: this is the second catch). |

Already Grabbed + catch = Dragged, no roll. Burt may burn one equipment once per round to cancel an attack at his node (**Prepared for Anything**).

Health: **Healthy** → **Injured** → **Critical (2 rounds)** → **Dead**. Val goes Critical after the second serious hit. Shaken: +1 Noise on ordinary Move/Run (not careful). Medkit at the node: Crit → Injured or Injured → Healthy.

TERRAIN

**Building** — first Graboid test Compromises it (holds once); later Unsafe. **Tower** — cannot be grabbed; open ground below becomes Unsafe. **Metal** — louder (printed N). **Open / road** — exposed. **Solid Rock** (Water

Tower footing + Caterpillar pad) — revealed by Find the Safe Ground; no surface/catch there. Blocked routes cannot be walked.

MAP (PHASE 1 TOWN)

14 nodes. Main St N–S, Talcum Ln E–W, Chang's west of Main St. Burt / Rhonda / Jim sit off the lots.

| S | Nodes                                           |
|---|-------------------------------------------------|
| A | Telephone Line, Nestor's Trailer, Nancy's House |
| B | Chang's Market, Horse Corral                    |
| C | Burt & Heather's, Water Tower, Chang's Trailer  |
| D | Rhonda's Camp, Melvin's Place, Jim & Megan's    |
| E | Junkyard, Caterpillar, Bixby Road               |

CHARACTERS

Stats are Movement / Nerve / Search / Combat. Turn order Val → Earl → Rhonda → Burt.

|                        | M/N/S/C | Passives / weakness                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Signature (1×)                                                                                        |
|------------------------|---------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Val</b><br>Chang's  | 4/3/3/3 | Fast (+1 space, +1 N). Luck: 1 reroll/round (fail: +1 N). Don't Wait Around: start Unsafe/Threatened → +1 Move. Fragile: second hit → Critical. Injured: –1 Move.                                                         | <b>Run!</b> Move 4 nodes now, ignore extra terrain. Become Shaken.                                    |
| <b>Earl</b><br>Chang's | 3/5/2/3 | Knows When to Run: 1/round after another's Noise, move 1 toward them free. Keep Moving: action, clear Shaken here. Together: share a node → both +1 Nerve; if one is Injured, Earl is Shaken.                             | <b>Let's Get the Hell Out</b> — all here may move 1 with no extra N.                                  |
| <b>Rhonda</b><br>camp  | 3/3/5/2 | Seismologist: on a noise threshold, peek next Calamity (keep or bury). I Know Where It Is: action, reveal a Graboid in your node/sector. Don't Move: no Move this turn → next action 0 N. Combat 2. Injured: cannot bury. | <b>They're Under Us</b> — reveal all in your sector; move one underground worm to an adjacent sector. |
| <b>Burt</b><br>house   | 2/4/3/5 | Prepared: 1/round, spend kit to cancel an attack/breach here. Big Guns: may use heavy; Fight extra +2 N. Weakness: +1 N using equipment. Injured: Fight –1.                                                               | <b>Gun Collection</b> — Fight Combat +3, no ammo cost, +5 N.                                          |

Burt kit (draft 2): Rifle (Fight +1, heavy +2 N) · Shotgun (same node Fight +2, heavy) · Explosives (can wound, +5 N) · Ammo (reroll one Fight) · Binoculars (Hunt in adjacent sectors) · Improvised Weapon (anyone may Fight, no bonus).

OBJECTIVES

Work on-site. Failure changes the board; it is not an instant loss. Prototype draw: 3 / 2 / 1 from these lists.

ESSENTIAL — WORK 2

| Name                      | Where          | N | Pass / fail                                        |
|---------------------------|----------------|---|----------------------------------------------------|
| The Road Is Blocked       | Bixby Road     | 1 | Intel / highway Danger Zone, Aggression +1         |
| Get the Radio Working     | Telephone Line | 2 | +1 Rescue / Desperation +1 and +1 every 2 rounds   |
| Find Rhonda's Seismograph | Rhonda's Camp  | 0 | Learn loudest-node Hunt / blind hunting            |
| Secure a Heavy Vehicle    | Caterpillar    | 3 | Loader ready / starts damaged                      |
| Find the Safe Ground      | Junkyard       | 0 | Solid Rock on Cat pad + Water Tower / stays hidden |
| Meeting Point             | Chang's        | 1 | Assembly / survivors scatter if forced out         |

OPTIONAL

| Name                | Where           | W/N | Pass                                      |
|---------------------|-----------------|-----|-------------------------------------------|
| Raid Chang's        | Chang's         | 1/1 | Medkit + Distraction                      |
| Burt's Arsenal      | Burt's          | 1/4 | Explosives + Ammo (fail: Burt stuck here) |
| Gather Fuel         | Chang's Trailer | 1/2 | +3 Fuel                                   |
| Medical Supplies    | Jim & Megan's   | 1/1 | +2 Medkits                                |
| Save the Horses     | Horse Corral    | 1/1 | +2 Quiet Move tokens                      |
| Salvage the Trailer | Nestor's        | 1/2 | Loader carries everyone                   |
| The Basement        | Burt's          | 2/2 | Heavy kit (fail: building inaccessible)   |

Character (1): Burt—Prepared (arsenal card) · Rhonda—readings (reveal two Hunt/sectors) · Val & Earl—get Melvin (Distraction) · Nancy—Where's Mandy? (+1 Quiet Move).

SEARCH, ITEMS, RIGS

16-card deck, two of each. Shared supply. Use is an action (1-N floor unless Don't Move / Quiet token).

| Item           | Solo                                                          |
|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Tin Cans       | +2 N on an adjacent node                                      |
| Fishing Line   | Reveal every Graboid in your sector                           |
| Pipe           | Next Fight +1 Combat                                          |
| Black Powder   | Next Fight +2 Combat; +2 N now                                |
| Fuel Can       | +1 Fuel                                                       |
| Rope           | Pull Pinned/Threatened here or adjacent 1 clear (not Grabbed) |
| Radio Parts    | +1 Work on radio or loader here                               |
| Walkie-Talkies | Next character in order +1 action                             |

| Rig             | Parts          | Effect                                                  |
|-----------------|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Pipe Bomb       | Pipe + Powder  | 1 wound here or adjacent, no Fight roll, +4 N           |
| Tripwire Bait   | Cans + Line    | Next surface at a node you choose, no ambush            |
| Fire Bomb       | Fuel + Powder  | Force a surfaced worm here to dive at Hunt 1, +5 N      |
| Line Rescue     | Rope + Walkies | Pull Grabbed/Threatened from adjacent onto yours        |
| Field Generator | Parts + Fuel   | Clear Power Failure / Darkness; dump 2 lingering N here |

CALAMITY

30 cards, three acts, **not fully shuffled**: Act I on 4, Act II on 7 and 9, Act III on 11, **Get Out of Perfection** on 12. The round's noise band picks Quiet / Disturbed / Frenzy text. Edgar and Old Fred are flavour, not map spaces. Round 12 unfinished Essentials can end the game.

Printable map: print/map.html · This sheet is the live Phase 1 engine, compressed for the table. Valley fold-out is not in this prototype.